Teaching Statement

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Finance is more than a set of formulas. I focus on the economic reasoning behind them. A student who can discount cash flows has learned a calculation; a student who understands why has learned the economics. In my course, students do the work themselves. They build the valuation, choose the assumptions, and explain the conclusions they reach.

In Spring 2026, I taught MGF 402 (Investment Management) at the University at Buffalo, with 55 students. I designed the lectures, homework, exams, and capstone project. The course covers the valuation of bonds, stocks, and derivatives. In fixed income, students use Excel to price bonds by discounting future cash flows. In equity valuation, they learn dividend-discount and free-cash-flow models and estimate the discount rates needed to apply them. I teach students to estimate β from return data in Excel and use CAPM to estimate the cost of equity, then demonstrate how the same analysis can be done in R. In derivatives, I use the binomial option pricing model to show how replication and no-arbitrage provide a different approach to valuation, leading naturally to risk-neutral pricing.

The capstone project brings these ideas together. Each student selects a publicly traded company and carries the analysis through to a buy, hold, or sell recommendation they must defend. The emphasis shifts from mechanics to judgment. Students justify the assumptions behind their valuation and show how the answer changes when those assumptions change. Student feedback reflects this emphasis. One student wrote that the course focused on concepts, 'not just performing math calculations and spitting out answers", and left them understanding 'why we do the things we do".

This was my first semester teaching my own course, and the evaluations, with an 85% response rate, were encouraging. Students rated the course 4.4/5.0 on "intellectually challenging", above the university-wide average of 4.2. My highest-rated item was "instructor welcomed students to seek help" at 4.6/5.0, compared with 4.4 university-wide, and students rated "instructor clearly presented learning expectations" at 4.4/5.0. I try to make myself available when students need help, whether by answering questions after class, responding to emails, or working through additional examples.

The written comments also gave me useful guidance for improving the course. Several students asked for more practice between exams, and some found the pace challenging on technical topics. The next time I teach the course, I plan to add more problem sets and spend more class time on difficult material. I try to set a high bar while making sure students have the support and practice needed to meet it.

I am prepared to teach investments, portfolio management, corporate finance, derivatives, and financial modeling. I can also teach advanced courses in empirical asset pricing and market microstructure. My research gives me opportunities to bring current questions in market structure and trading into the classroom. The connection also runs the other way. Teaching pushes me to revisit core concepts, which deepens my own understanding and sometimes leads to ideas for future research.